

for dinner. It's something we both enjoy—entertaining guests. Another community we're a part of is our local gym. After cooking big meals for our friends and family, we need the exercise!

4. **Education.** This one's a big one: the better educated you are, the better off your marriage will be. And to take it a step further, the better educated a *woman* is, the better the chances of her marriage surviving. Gone are the days when a wife would drop out of school to work full time and put her husband through medical or business school. I encourage *both* partners to work to subsidize their education, even delaying marriage if need be. And by “education,” I don't just mean university—I'm counting trade and vocational training, too. In these volatile times, broad skills and having two earners with different backgrounds can mean doubling the chance of employability.
5. **Money.** Here's where the average matchmaker could learn a thing or two from me. I'm no psychiatrist, but I do understand money. I understand how having it creates joy and stability in a relationship—and how the lack of it can drive a wedge between even the closest couples. If you and your partner don't speak the same money language, you're destined for financial ruin. If you go into marriage with crushing debt, you're headed for trouble from the time you exchange vows. If your partner has proven him or herself to be incapable of spending judiciously and saving well, then trust me: somewhere out there is a better match for you.